



MPEG-2 is the most commonly used compression Codec for digital HDTV broadcasts. Although MPEG-2 supports up to 4:2:2 YUV chroma subsampling and 10-bit quantisation, HD broadcasts use 4:2:0 and 8-bit quantisation to save bandwidth. Some broadcasters also plan to use MPEG-4 which will enable it provide even better audio quality with higher resolution pictures and a theatre-like experience on your HDTV-compatible TV set. This also means that recording of TV programs would require a new technology as well.

HDTV can be recorded on D-VHS (Data-VHS), W-VHS, or on a HDTV-capable digital video recorder such as DirecTV's high-definition TiVo or DISH Network's DVR 921 or 942, or to a computer which has a HDTV capture card installed. HDTV cannot be recorded on a standard storage media; it would require at least a Blu-Ray DVD or HD-DVD.

However, not all HDTV's come with an inbuilt tuner (also known as ATSC tuner). Most of them come with a direct-plug in-